Rafiq AI

Pre- seed | August 2025

Imagine Accessible, Equitable, Scalable & Contextualized education.

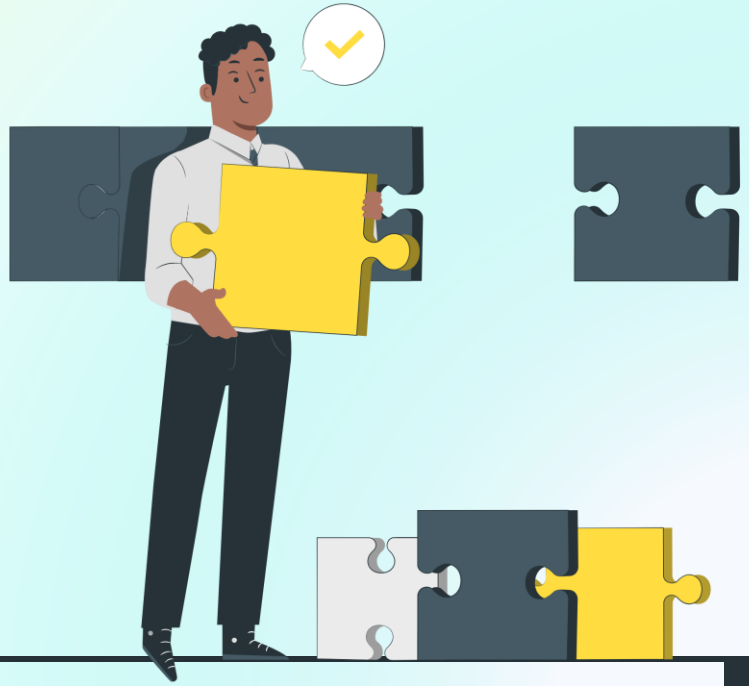
Our vision is to nurture the growth and wellbeing of every teacher, believing that their empowered practice is the heart of a vibrant, equitable, and transformative learning environment where every student can thrive.

There is little attention paid to meeting teachers where they are.

Across the Arab World and Africa, professional development is growing—but teachers are still struggling

1. Gap between Professional development & classroom practice
2. Lack of contextualization in reforms
3. Schools lack tools to track coaching impact

$2.3B+ is wasted annually on ineffective training, and millions of students fall behind in foundational skills.



AI-powered App and human coaching to bridge the gap between professional development and classroom practice

Generative AI-powered SaaS platform that delivers **personalized instructional coaching** and professional development for teachers at scale.

Gen-AI automation and human coaching to provide scalable, **context-driven professional development** that improves classroom outcomes.

Although 500,000 teachers are needed annually, yet professional development is generic and disconnected

AI presents an opportunity because:

- Demand is urgent
- Tech is ready
- Education budgets are shifting.

Based on decade of experience we found three key challenges for sustainability:

- Expanding impact,
- Increasing human coaches to reach more teachers,
- Creating systemic peer coaching methods.

We have designed Rafiq AI features to match teachers' needs.

Rafiq AI Coach

1. Co-creates with teacher professional growth goals,
2. Co-creates a realistic plan,
3. Reflective exercises to monitor progress.
4. Data-driven insights and Progress reports.

Human-AI Connection

1. Conduct 15-20 min observations
2. Automate reflection prompts
3. Recommend classroom activities
4. AI coach reports back to human coach.

Professional Portfolio

1. Provides guidance on documenting teaching innovations
2. Tracking student engagement
3. Gathering evidence of impact.

Rafiq AI is a community of practice and collaboration.

Personalized lessons

The AI suggests differentiated activities to engage all learners based on input from teacher, provides coaching tips to implement the activities

Peer Squad chat

Teachers can share challenges and experiences with other teachers and get support

Bite-sized practice

The AI provides teachers with chunked practice-based learning modules that fit teacher's schedule and needs.

A $115 billion market spanning Arab World and North Africa, 7 million in service teachers

The overall education market in MENA is currently valued at about $115 billion and is projected to reach $175 billion by 2027

- **Economic reforms** like Saudi Vision 2030 and digital talent strategies in the UAE, Saudi Arabia, and Egypt **are boosting educator development**.
- **EdTech adoption is rising**, backed by over **$1.5 billion in Q1 2025** venture funding.
- In 2025, **MENA has about 7 million teachers** and **over 100 million students,** representing a major youth education sector.

Professional Development Market [Market Report Analytics]
MENA Executive Education Statistics [Digital Defynd]

Plus 300,00 to 500,000 Pre-service teachers to expand our market - a B2B service offering

1. The practicum component of teacher ed programs involves supervision and mentoring like our observations and coaching features.

2. Arab region and North Africa sustain a pipeline of about 300,000 to 500,000 pre-service teachers annually

3. Supervision of pre-service teachers, usually through guided practicums, mentorship, and teaching practice placements, is a standard component in teacher education programs across many countries.

Zaalouk: UNESCO TPD Arab States during COVID-19-pandemic

While Competitors have Limited Focus, We Think Access, Scale, and Equity

LUMIVERO

Automating placement, evaluation and tracking activity logs. Specific for pre-service teacher supervision.

EDTHENA

AI-powered coaching platform for both pre-service and in-service teachers.

LevelData

A complete school LMS, "Grow" helps in-service coaching , features include documenting observation notes and analyzing data from coaching.

Rafiq AI is unique because:

- It is an App not platform, this makes it easy and accessible for teachers in the school setting.
- Can support both in-service and pre-service teachers
- Offers AI-powered coaching in addition to human coaching which allows for scalability

Previous Pilots prove teachers achieve their potential and more: 'This makes it a good solution'

I once believed **corporal punishment** was the only way to handle difficult children, until a profound coaching session moved me to tears and **helped me see the child's perspective.** This began a journey of self-directed growth, where my coach and I experimented with **new methods without judgment**. Coaching has become a continuous journey of mutual support, **respect, and collaborative learning.**

Jamila ⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐

I have always loved teaching but felt **frustrated** by my inability to engage my students or manage my classroom. Through a supportive, consistent coaching relationship, I overcame my resistance to change and learned to **embrace new methods of teaching**. This transformation eventually led me from a struggling teacher to **becoming the principal** of the very same school

Hana ⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐

As a physical training teacher, I initially **doubted** how a professional development program could apply to my work outside the classroom. Through a supportive coaching relationship built on **trust** and methods like **video reflection**, I gained a **new perspective** and saw my role as an educator differently. This transformative journey completely **changed my thinking and led me to my current role** as an instructional coach for new teachers.

Rim ⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐

We are leaders, educators, and technologists who live a mission of quality education for “ALL”

Meet Shereen, our CEO and PhD student in education from UGA and 20 years of experience.

- Shereen has over 10 years of experience in working with teachers and educators.
- She was an instructional coach for over 6 years at the American university in Cairo
- She has 2 years experience of using design thinking principles to redesign a children's reading App. She developed user stories and collaborated closely with UX/UI designers on the app's entire design.
- She also orchestrated global user testing (Kenya, India, Peru, US), leading to a successful launch in January 2024.

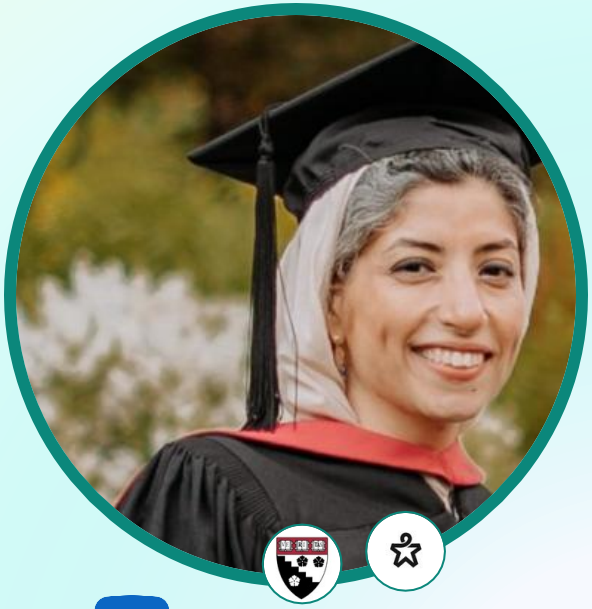
Shereen Aly

Meet Nermin, our COO with masters in education from Harvard and 12 years of experience in education

- Nermin ElKammar has 12 years experience, with children, youth, and adults, working for local NGOs and Startups in the Education sector in Egypt, playing different roles in various domains of education including education management, curriculum design, teacher training design and delivery, and instructional coaching, and more.

- She holds a Master of Education - MEd, in Education Leadership, Organizations, and Entrepreneurship from Harvard Graduate School of Education, in 2024, and Former teaching fellow at HGSE.

- Nermin is currently an Educational Consultant with Right to Dream, Egypt



Nermin ElKammar

Meet Ahmed, our CTO who built 3 tech-startups from the ground up with 22 years experience in Entrepreneurship.

- Ahmed Youssry is the founder and managing partner at Ready4vc. A management consultancy focused on consulting and advising founders on raising their first institutional round, Ahmed has 22 years of experience as an entrepreneur, a manager, a consultant, and a coach.
- In 2009 Ahmed cofounded Healthy food, a Social enterprise to microfinance small farmers and distribute fresh food.
- In 2013 he managed Yomken.com as an MD managing the first Arab open-innovation and crowdfunding hybrid platform operation.
- In 2020 he led the matchmaking department at S[k]aleUp Venture, headhunting startups, managing due Diligence, storytelling, mentoring, and supporting portfolio companies.

Ahmed Youssry

Nermin and Shereen worked together for 7 years now

Our journey **togther** began in rural Egypt, and we are proud of how the team grew and what we were able to achieve.

- Over 80 teachers in 3 community schools across Egypt
- A well designed 5-years professional development program, all teachers engage in professional development and personalized coaching across the year.
- Teachers have three professional paths through which they can get promoted: coaching, PD trainer, and administration.
- All schools are run by principles and leadership staff that are grown from within the community schools.

Nermin and Shereen work well together, we have synergy, shared values and complementary skills that make our work together productive and joyful.

We're seeking guidance to market entry , expand pilots, refine the product, and grow impact

Now we are building our MVP

- Researching pains and gains with teachers.
- Prototyping in Figma.
- Prototyping AI Agent orchestration schema.

We seek support in

- Strategic decisions, Market entry, networking & hiring.
- Pre-seed financial support to build the testing MVP